

ENGLISH FOR WORK / SEPTEMBER 2026

Warehouse and Distribution English



Learner workbook

Work with realistic cases, develop your own response, and use the answer section after you have tried the tasks.

PRACTICE THAT TRANSFERS TO WORK

Read a realistic case. Study complete conversations. Find the right language, speak, get feedback, and try again.

Eight lessons | Intermediate to advanced | Independent or classroom study

For Warehouse associates, receivers, pickers, packers, returns staff, and inventory clerks.

All cases, quantities, codes, people, and arrangements are fictional English practice, not warehouse, equipment, lifting, hazardous-material, or safety training. Local stock controls and duties vary. Use employer training for physical tasks; refer equipment operation, hazardous conditions, inventory adjustments, and release decisions to the responsible qualified staff. Scripts teach communication, not handling methods.

All scenarios, figures, and model responses are fictional teaching material. Use invented details in practice.

Open this course on English Ladder

Your course at a glance

Use the lesson numbers to match this document with the website and the other guides.

01 Receiving against the expected shipment

Separate receipt facts from a purchasing decision.

02 Locating and identifying stock

Clarify an item-location conflict before relying on the location sign.

03 Picking the right unit and quantity

Prevent a correct number being used with the wrong unit.

04 Reporting a short pick and replenishment need

Request a quantity-specific check without treating reserve stock as immediately pickable.

05 Packing and label discrepancies

Name the conflicting identifiers and request a focused check.

06 Staging and dispatch status

Explain why prepared goods are not yet a completed dispatch.

07 Returns and stock status

State a return's actual status without inferring saleability.

08 Inventory and shift handoffs

Hand over count evidence, remaining work, and ownership.

Choose your pace

Quick practice: spend 15 minutes reading one conversation and rehearsing one scenario. Full lesson: allow 45-60 minutes for language work, three conversations, two speaking scenarios, and feedback.

Level support

B1 learners can use the frames and a partner. B2 learners can try a response before reading the model. C1 learners can add the harder follow-up and reduce preparation time. These are teaching suggestions, not certified CEFR level ratings.

After practicing: open the AI prompt workshop, or use the prompts at the end of this guide.

LESSON 01 / READ AND NOTICE

Receiving against the expected shipment

Separate receipt facts from a purchasing decision.

SITUATION

Purchase order 740 expects twenty cartons. Receiving counts twenty-two with matching item labels. The supplier has not explained the additional two; the clerk can flag an overage but cannot approve an order change.

1. Understand the situation

Identify two confirmed facts, one missing detail, and the person who needs your response. Do not fill gaps with invented facts.

2. Find the words

advance shipping notice - A supplier's message describing goods expected to arrive, often shortened to ASN.

receiving discrepancy - A difference between an arriving shipment and its expected quantity, identity, or condition.

purchase order - A buyer's order identifying requested goods and quantities, often shortened to PO.

overage - A quantity received above the quantity expected for that shipment.

Useful word combinations

compare the expected quantity: check arrival against the notice

report an overage: identify extra units with their reference

match the purchase order: link goods to the buyer's order

keep the discrepancy open: avoid calling an unresolved difference settled

LESSON 01 / LANGUAGE AND PRACTICE

Report the extra quantity precisely

3. Notice the language

A matching label does not by itself approve an order increase.

We expected ____; we counted ____.

The labels match, but ____ remains unclear.

Please refer the quantity difference to ____.

Compare this wording: The order is now twenty-two.

Clearer: Twenty-two arrived against an expected twenty; the extra two need review.

Arrival changes the observed count, not automatically the order.

4. Check the language

1. Receiver: Twenty were expected and twenty-two arrived.

Clerk: That is an ____ of two cartons.

- A. balance
- B. allocation
- C. overage
- D. shortage

2. Buyer: Did matching labels approve the extra cartons?

Clerk: No. They help confirm ____, not an increase to the order.

- A. the amended purchase-order total
- B. the supplier's instruction to send extras
- C. the buyer's acceptance of extras
- D. the received item's identity

05 • Conversations

The next three pages contain original fictional conversations for this lesson. Each numbered line is one speaking turn. Read the setting before assigning roles.

LESSON 01 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 1 OF 3

Two cartons above the order

Receiving clerk and buyer discuss purchase order 740.

01 • Receiver: Purchase order seven forty expects twenty cartons, but our receiving count is twenty-two today.

02 • Buyer: Do the extra cartons carry the same item code as the twenty we ordered?

03 • Receiver: Yes, the labels match. That confirms identity, but not why the quantity increased.

04 • Buyer: I haven't approved an increase. Please keep the expected quantity at twenty during my supplier check.

05 • Receiver: I'll report this receiving discrepancy as a two-carton overage, without changing the purchase order.

06 • Buyer: Thank you. Are you also reporting a contents difference inside any of those cartons?

07 • Receiver: No. This report concerns outer-carton count only; individual contents have not been checked.

08 • Buyer: Then I'll ask the supplier about the additional two cartons using that exact distinction.

09 • Receiver: Who should receive the supplier's explanation when it arrives so the discrepancy can be reviewed?

10 • Buyer: Send it to receiving against seven forty. I'll remain the contact for the purchasing decision.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 01 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 2 OF 3

The shipping notice names another site

A receiver queries an arrival notice with a carrier driver.

01 • Receiver: The advance shipping notice names our west warehouse, but this is the east distribution site.

02 • Driver: My delivery document lists the east address. Can we compare the shipment reference before deciding?

03 • Receiver: Both show N82, twelve cartons of display stands. The site names are the conflicting detail.

04 • Driver: Then it isn't enough to say the item and quantity match; the destination needs clarification.

05 • Receiver: I'll contact our receiving desk with both document versions and keep that destination question explicit.

06 • Driver: Dispatch can check my delivery booking too. I won't claim either address is corrected yet.

07 • Receiver: Is there a later document on your side that could explain a destination change?

08 • Driver: This one was issued yesterday afternoon. I don't know when your advance notice was created.

09 • Receiver: Ours dates from Monday. I'll report both dates without assuming the newer address is correct.

10 • Driver: Agreed. The desks can confirm the intended site before this is recorded as a completed receipt.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 01 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 3 OF 3

One arrival divided between purchase orders

A receiver checks an apparent overage with a purchasing clerk.

01 • Receiver: Nine cartons arrived together, but purchase order four ten only lists five. Are four extra?

02 • Purchasing clerk: Check the references on the carton labels. We also ordered four cartons under four eleven.

03 • Receiver: Five labels show four ten; the other four show four eleven with the same supplier.

04 • Purchasing clerk: Then these are two expected receipts arriving together, not an overage against the first order.

05 • Receiver: I'll keep the quantities separate rather than receive all nine against four ten.

06 • Purchasing clerk: Please do. The departments need distinct receipt records even though the supplier used one vehicle.

07 • Receiver: Does either order include a change to the item description that receiving should query?

08 • Purchasing clerk: No changes are confirmed. Compare each order with its own listed items as usual.

09 • Receiver: So five against four ten and four against four eleven, with no quantity difference currently identified.

10 • Purchasing clerk: Correct. That resolves the apparent extra quantity without altering either purchase order.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 01 / 06 • SAY IT

Two scenarios to practice

Use only the supplied facts. Prepare for two minutes, speak for one minute, then respond to a follow-up. Switch roles and repeat. For solo study, speak both roles aloud.

Scenario 1 | Receiving against the expected shipment

Purchase order 740 expects twenty cartons. Receiving counts twenty-two with matching item labels. The supplier has not explained the additional two; the clerk can flag an overage but cannot approve an order change.

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: Buyer: only twenty were ordered; you must ask the supplier about the additional two.

Second round: A colleague suggests replacing the expected quantity with the count. Explain why both figures matter.

Scenario 2 | The delivery has one fewer pallet

Notice A09 expects four pallets; three arrive. Each pallet's carton contents remain unchecked. Supplier has not confirmed a separate shipment.

Role A: Receiver: state the missing handling unit accurately.

Role B: Receiving clerk: ask whether the count concerns pallets or cartons.

Possible opening: We received three of four pallets, not three of four cartons.

Success checks

- State one pallet short.
- Do not invent contents quantity.
- Ask for the matching packing detail.

Add a complication: Someone wants to call the missing pallet twenty missing cartons without a packing breakdown.

Check: facts accurate | meaning clear | tone appropriate | next action or question explicit

Continue scenario 1 with an AI partner.

LESSON 02 / READ AND NOTICE

Locating and identifying stock

Clarify an item-location conflict before relying on the location sign.

SITUATION

A picker needs item BK-14-B, blue folders. Bin A12 contains BK-14-G, green folders. The bin sign says BK-14-B. Inventory clerk can check the putaway record; no move or substitution has been approved.

1. Understand the situation

Identify two confirmed facts, one missing detail, and the person who needs your response. Do not fill gaps with invented facts.

2. Find the words

stock keeping unit - An identifier for a distinct stocked product or variant, commonly shortened to SKU.

bin location - The coded storage position assigned to stock within a warehouse.

lot number - An identifier linking units produced or supplied as one particular batch.

putaway - The placement and recording of received goods in their assigned storage locations.

Useful word combinations

read the full item code: include the variant suffix

verify the bin location: confirm the assigned storage position

check the lot number: distinguish batches of the same product

query the putaway record: ask where receipt was recorded as stored

LESSON 02 / LANGUAGE AND PRACTICE

Read beyond a shared code prefix

3. Notice the language

Product, variant, lot, and location identify different things. Repeat the full code.

The task specifies ____; the carton shows ____.

Is ____ the location code or the item code?

Please check the record for ____.

Compare this wording: It's basically the same code.

Clearer: The suffix is G, but the requested blue variant ends in B.

The suffix identifies a different variant.

4. Check the language

1. Picker: Both codes begin BK-14. Are the variants identical?

Clerk: No; check the final ____.

A. lot number

B. quantity

C. suffix

D. prefix

2. Picker: Does A12 identify the product?

Clerk: Here it identifies the ____.

A. item variant

B. batch

C. order line

D. bin location

05 • Conversations

The next three pages contain original fictional conversations for this lesson. Each numbered line is one speaking turn. Read the setting before assigning roles.

LESSON 02 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 1 OF 3

Blue on the task, green in the bin

A picker reports item identification conflicts in A12.

01 • Picker: My task specifies BK-14-B, blue folders, but the cartons in A12 show BK-14-G.

02 • Inventory clerk: The bin sign says blue too. Could you read the full carton description aloud?

03 • Picker: Green folders, stock keeping unit BK-14-G. The prefix matches, but the variant suffix differs.

04 • Inventory clerk: That points to an item-location discrepancy, not proof that the green variant is an acceptable substitute.

05 • Picker: Can you check the putaway record before I treat those cartons as the requested stock?

06 • Inventory clerk: Yes. I'll compare the recorded locations for both variants rather than change your requested item.

07 • Picker: I haven't selected them for the order. The mismatch affects the blue-folder pick only.

08 • Inventory clerk: Good. Does another carton there have the blue suffix, or are they all labeled green?

09 • Picker: The visible labels I checked are green; I can't confirm stock elsewhere in the warehouse.

10 • Inventory clerk: I'll investigate both records and keep any unverified alternative location separate from this confirmed mismatch.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 02 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 2 OF 3

A lot number is not a shelf number

A warehouse associate asks a colleague to clarify an instruction.

01 • Associate: You asked me to check 316. Is that a bin location or a lot number?

02 • Stock clerk: It's lot three sixteen for the gray notebook sleeves, currently recorded in bin C08.

03 • Associate: Thank you. I was looking at aisle three because I misunderstood which identifier you meant.

04 • Stock clerk: The item code is NS-G. Lot three sixteen identifies a batch of that same product.

05 • Associate: So I need the item, lot, and location together, not just the number three sixteen.

06 • Stock clerk: Exactly. Another batch of NS-G is also stored here, so the lot distinction matters.

07 • Associate: Could you repeat the requested combination once so I can check my understanding aloud?

08 • Stock clerk: NS-G, gray sleeves, lot three sixteen, location C08. This is an identification check, not a stock move.

09 • Associate: Understood. I'll compare the identifiers without treating this check as permission to move stock.

10 • Stock clerk: That's the check I need. Let me know which identifier differs if you find a mismatch.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 02 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 3 OF 3

A location changed but the sign did not

A picker queries a revised stock location with inventory staff.

01 • Picker: The task sends me to D20, but the printed sign for these envelopes still names D18.

02 • Inventory clerk: The system shows a location change yesterday. Which item code are you checking right now?

03 • Picker: EN-50, the fifty-pack. D20's cartons match that code, while the old sign is at D18.

04 • Inventory clerk: That supports checking an outdated sign, but let's verify the recorded move before changing location information.

05 • Picker: I don't want tomorrow's picker to follow the old sign and report an unnecessary shortage.

06 • Inventory clerk: The move record confirms EN-50 was reassigned to D20 yesterday afternoon; the sign replacement is outstanding.

07 • Picker: Then I can describe D20 as the confirmed location and the D18 sign as awaiting correction?

08 • Inventory clerk: Yes. I'll take the sign correction request so both references give the same location.

09 • Picker: Please distinguish EN-50 from EN-100; their old signs are next to each other.

10 • Inventory clerk: I will. The confirmed change applies only to the fifty-pack, not every envelope item.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 02 / 06 • SAY IT

Two scenarios to practice

Use only the supplied facts. Prepare for two minutes, speak for one minute, then respond to a follow-up. Switch roles and repeat. For solo study, speak both roles aloud.

Scenario 1 | Locating and identifying stock

A picker needs item BK-14-B, blue folders. Bin A12 contains BK-14-G, green folders. The bin sign says BK-14-B. Inventory clerk can check the putaway record; no move or substitution has been approved.

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: Inventory clerk: task and sign say blue; carton labels say green; investigate the putaway history.

Second round: A matching photograph is offered as proof. Ask for the full item identifier instead.

Scenario 2 | A similar item description without its code

Pick request says 'large clear box'; two variants exist: BX-L with lid and BX-O without. Order line specifies BX-L.

Role A: Picker: ask for the full identifier.

Role B: Order clerk: read BX-L and the with-lid description.

Possible opening: Does large clear box mean the lidded version or the open version?

Success checks

- Confirm BX-L.
- Name the lid distinction.
- Keep any substitution separate from identification.

Add a complication: A colleague offers the open version because its dimensions match.

Check: facts accurate | meaning clear | tone appropriate | next action or question explicit

Continue scenario 1 with an AI partner.

LESSON 03 / READ AND NOTICE

Picking the right unit and quantity

Prevent a correct number being used with the wrong unit.

SITUATION

Pick ticket S18 asks for six each of a storage tray. A standard case holds six trays. A coworker reads it as six cases. Confirm one case contains the six requested units, without assuming other products share that pack size.

1. Understand the situation

Identify two confirmed facts, one missing detail, and the person who needs your response. Do not fill gaps with invented facts.

2. Find the words

unit of measure - The counting basis used for an item, such as each, case, or pallet.

each - One individual sale or stock unit, rather than a group of units.

case pack - The number of individual units supplied in a standard case.

pick ticket - The instruction identifying items, quantities, and locations for an order pick.

Useful word combinations

confirm the unit of measure: establish what the quantity counts

pick by each: count individual units for the order

check the case pack: verify units per case

read back the pick quantity: repeat amount and counting unit together

LESSON 03 / LANGUAGE AND PRACTICE

Make the counting unit audible

3. Notice the language

Say the amount and unit together. A case pack varies by item.

The ticket says ___ each, not ___ cases.

For this item, one case contains ___.

Please repeat the quantity with ___.

Compare this wording: Pick six.

Clearer: Pick six individual trays; this item's case pack is six.

The phrase removes the unit ambiguity.

4. Check the language

1. Picker: Six each means six ___ trays.

Partner: Yes, not six cases.

A. individual

B. additional

C. assorted

D. repacked

2. Partner: Is the case pack six for every product?

Picker: That figure applies ___ this item.

A. with

B. to

C. by

D. from

05 • Conversations

The next three pages contain original fictional conversations for this lesson. Each numbered line is one speaking turn. Read the setting before assigning roles.

LESSON 03 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 1 OF 3

Six trays rather than six cases

Two pickers clarify the counting unit on S18.

01 • Picker: The pick ticket for S18 says six each; I initially read that as six cases.

02 • Partner: The unit of measure is each: six individual trays, not six case packs.

03 • Picker: The product record says six per case. Does that make the requested quantity one complete case?

04 • Partner: Yes, for this item. One case contains the six trays requested on this ticket.

05 • Picker: I'll repeat it: six individual trays, corresponding to one case of this specific product.

06 • Partner: That's right. Please keep the case pack linked to this item rather than every tray.

07 • Picker: I noticed the wider tray beside it has eight per case, which could confuse someone.

08 • Partner: Exactly. The same word tray doesn't establish the same unit count or item identifier.

09 • Picker: I'll confirm the code and unit together when I pass the pick to packing.

10 • Partner: Then packing should hear six trays for S18, not the ambiguous instruction to check six.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 03 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 2 OF 3

A pair is the selling unit

A picker clarifies a glove order with the order desk.

01 • Picker: This ticket requests eight pairs of gloves. The product photo shows two gloves together.

02 • Order clerk: That's because a pair is the selling unit: one left glove and one right glove.

03 • Picker: So eight pairs means sixteen individual gloves, not eight gloves divided into four pairs?

04 • Order clerk: Correct. Keep the order quantity expressed as eight pairs so the unit stays clear.

05 • Picker: The storage label also lists cartons of twelve pairs. That isn't the requested quantity here.

06 • Order clerk: Right. The carton pack describes the supplier packaging, not how many pairs this order needs.

07 • Picker: I'll report eight pairs picked rather than just saying eight, which could mean single gloves.

08 • Order clerk: Please include the size as well; this order is for medium, not large.

09 • Picker: Medium gloves, eight pairs, item GM-2. I'll keep those details together in the handoff.

10 • Order clerk: That matches the order. The photo doesn't replace checking the specified unit and size.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 03 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 3 OF 3

The decimal belongs to weight

A picker checks a stock line with a warehouse clerk.

01 • Picker: My screen shows twelve units and 2.5 beside them. Is the second figure another quantity?

02 • Clerk: That field is listed weight in kilograms per unit, not an extra picking amount.

03 • Picker: The narrow display hid the field heading. I wanted to check before interpreting the decimal.

04 • Clerk: Good question. The order quantity remains twelve units of item WT-8 on this ticket.

05 • Picker: So I should not say twelve and a half, or convert the weight into a unit count?

06 • Clerk: No. Those figures describe different measurements, and the task doesn't ask you to combine them.

07 • Picker: Please include the weight-field heading in the spoken handoff to packing.

08 • Clerk: I'll say twelve units requested; listed weight is two point five kilograms per unit.

09 • Picker: Thank you. I'll read the quantity and the item code together when confirming the pick.

10 • Clerk: That keeps the number twelve attached to units and the decimal attached to its weight field.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 03 / 06 • SAY IT

Two scenarios to practice

Use only the supplied facts. Prepare for two minutes, speak for one minute, then respond to a follow-up. Switch roles and repeat. For solo study, speak both roles aloud.

Scenario 1 | Picking the right unit and quantity

Pick ticket S18 asks for six each of a storage tray. A standard case holds six trays. A coworker reads it as six cases. Confirm one case contains the six requested units, without assuming other products share that pack size.

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: Coworker: you initially understood six cases; repeat the corrected quantity.

Second round: Another tray has a case pack of eight. Explain why the S18 calculation does not transfer to it.

Scenario 2 | Three cartons of ten, not ten cartons

Order X16 asks for thirty each; item record states ten per carton. A partner says ten cartons because ten is prominent on the label.

Role A: Picker: clarify all three quantities.

Role B: Partner: confirm thirty individual units in three complete cartons for this item.

Possible opening: Which number is the order quantity and which is the pack size?

Success checks

- Keep thirty each as requested.
- Explain three cartons of ten.
- Do not apply the neighboring variant's pack size.

Add a complication: A neighboring variant contains twelve per carton.

Check: facts accurate | meaning clear | tone appropriate | next action or question explicit

Continue scenario 1 with an AI partner.

LESSON 04 / READ AND NOTICE

Reporting a short pick and replenishment need

Request a quantity-specific check without treating reserve stock as immediately pickable.

SITUATION

Order D55 needs ten baskets; pick face B04 has four. System lists twelve in reserve, but allocation and availability have not been checked. Replenishment desk can review; cutoff is 15:00.

1. Understand the situation

Identify two confirmed facts, one missing detail, and the person who needs your response. Do not fill gaps with invented facts.

2. Find the words

short pick - A pick that cannot supply the full requested quantity from the identified available stock.

replenishment - The movement of stock into a picking location from another storage area.

reserve stock - Stock held outside the main picking location for later use.

allocation - Stock assigned or reserved for a particular order or purpose.

Useful word combinations

report the short pick: state requested and available quantities

request replenishment: ask for stock at the pick location

check reserve availability: distinguish stored quantity from usable quantity

confirm the allocation: verify which order the stock belongs to

LESSON 04 / LANGUAGE AND PRACTICE

Ask for the missing stock information

3. Notice the language

Reserve quantity, order allocation, and completed replenishment are different statuses.

The short pick is ___ units for order ___.

Reserve shows ___, but ___ needs checking.

Can you confirm ___ before ___?

Compare this wording: There is stock, so we're fine.

Clearer: Reserve shows twelve; availability for D55 and replenishment are still unconfirmed.

The revised update names the actual dependency.

4. Check the language

1. Picker: Four are available against ten requested.

Desk: The short pick is ___ units.

- A. six
- B. ten
- C. twelve
- D. four

2. Desk: Are those reserve units definitely free for D55?

Picker: Their ___ still needs checking.

- A. bin label
- B. allocation
- C. pack size
- D. physical condition

05 • Conversations

The next three pages contain original fictional conversations for this lesson. Each numbered line is one speaking turn. Read the setting before assigning roles.

LESSON 04 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 1 OF 3

Six baskets short at B04

A picker calls the replenishment desk about D55.

01 • Picker: D55 needs ten baskets, but B04 has four. The short pick is six units.

02 • Replenishment clerk: I see twelve listed in reserve. Have you confirmed whether those are allocated elsewhere?

03 • Picker: No, that's the check I need. The system quantity alone doesn't show availability for D55.

04 • Replenishment clerk: I'll review allocation and the replenishment request. What carrier cutoff affects this order?

05 • Picker: Three o'clock. Please tell me the status before then, even if the six remain unavailable.

06 • Replenishment clerk: Understood. Accepting your request doesn't mean the pick location has already been replenished.

07 • Picker: I'll keep the pick status at four available, six outstanding until the actual stock change is confirmed.

08 • Replenishment clerk: That's accurate. If reserve belongs to another order, I'll report that constraint specifically.

09 • Picker: Please also name the next update time so packing doesn't assume the remaining six are already coming.

10 • Replenishment clerk: I can update you at two fifteen with availability and the replenishment status separately.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 04 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 2 OF 3

The reserve quantity is committed elsewhere

A picker discusses unavailable reserve stock with an allocation clerk.

01 • Picker: The screen shows twenty lamps in reserve. Could those cover my five-unit shortage on L30?

02 • Allocation clerk: They are allocated to order L22, so I can't describe them as free for L30.

03 • Picker: Thanks. I need to explain why visible reserve stock isn't automatically available for my pick.

04 • Allocation clerk: You can say stock exists but is assigned elsewhere. Reallocation would require a separate decision.

05 • Picker: I won't mark the five supplied merely because someone could potentially approve that change.

06 • Allocation clerk: Correct. I can send the request for review, but its outcome is not known.

07 • Picker: Please include L30's five-unit shortage and afternoon cutoff so the review has the actual constraint.

08 • Allocation clerk: I will. Keep the physical reserve count separate from the quantity available to your order.

09 • Picker: Then my update to packing is five outstanding, with reallocation requested but not confirmed.

10 • Allocation clerk: That captures it. I'll return the decision when the responsible planner has reviewed the competing orders.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 04 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 3 OF 3

Replenished in the record, not at the location

A picker checks a task-status discrepancy with a stock associate.

01 • Picker: R28 shows complete, but its named pick location is empty.

02 • Stock associate: Which task and location are you referring to? I need those before comparing the movement record.

03 • Picker: Task R28 for item CF-6, destination B09. I haven't checked any other storage position.

04 • Stock associate: The completion entry names B90. That could explain the discrepancy, but the physical location needs verification.

05 • Picker: Please don't change my pick to B90 solely because those characters appear in the record.

06 • Stock associate: Agreed. I'll ask the movement team to check the recorded destination and report the actual finding.

07 • Picker: I'll tell packing the replenishment status is disputed, rather than simply say the stock disappeared.

08 • Stock associate: That is more accurate. We have a record-location mismatch, not a confirmed loss.

09 • Picker: Could you keep R28 attached to the investigation so the next shift can follow it?

10 • Stock associate: I'll take the location check and update the pick desk with the findings.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 04 / 06 • SAY IT

Two scenarios to practice

Use only the supplied facts. Prepare for two minutes, speak for one minute, then respond to a follow-up. Switch roles and repeat. For solo study, speak both roles aloud.

Scenario 1 | Reporting a short pick and replenishment need

Order D55 needs ten baskets; pick face B04 has four. System lists twelve in reserve, but allocation and availability have not been checked. Replenishment desk can review; cutoff is 15:00.

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: Replenishment desk: reserve exists, but another order may have priority; confirm the actual status.

Second round: The replenishment request is accepted. Explain why accepted does not yet mean the pick face has been refilled.

Scenario 2 | A partial replenishment

Request R50 asks for eight units. Four have reached the pick location; four remain unconfirmed. Order clerk asks whether the request is complete.

Role A: Picker: report four supplied and four outstanding.

Role B: Clerk: you need a clear status for packing, not a new stock promise.

Possible opening: Have all eight arrived, or only the first four?

Success checks

- State the partial quantity.
- Distinguish acknowledgment from replenishment.
- Ask who owns the remaining four.

Add a complication: A task acknowledgment is mistaken for physical completion.

Check: facts accurate | meaning clear | tone appropriate | next action or question explicit

Continue scenario 1 with an AI partner.

LESSON 05 / READ AND NOTICE

Packing and label discrepancies

Name the conflicting identifiers and request a focused check.

SITUATION

Packing station 3 has cartons C70 and C71. C70's screen names Harbor Shop, but the loose label beside it names Hillside School for C71. No label has been applied. Ask the packer to pause the label match while both references are checked.

1. Understand the situation

Identify two confirmed facts, one missing detail, and the person who needs your response. Do not fill gaps with invented facts.

2. Find the words

packing station - The work area where picked goods are checked and prepared for dispatch.

shipping label - The label carrying delivery and carrier information for a shipment.

carton identifier - A unique reference used to distinguish a particular shipping carton.

scan confirmation - A system acknowledgment that a particular barcode or item scan was registered.

Useful word combinations

match the carton identifier: link the physical carton and record

query a label mismatch: flag conflicting shipping information

confirm the scan result: check which reference was registered

separate adjacent orders: keep goods and labels linked to the right customer

LESSON 05 / LANGUAGE AND PRACTICE

Interrupt a mismatched label politely

3. Notice the language

Physical proximity does not prove that a loose label belongs to a carton.

Please pause ____; these references differ.

The screen says ____, whereas the label says ____.

Let's compare ____ before ____.

Compare this wording: That label looks close enough.

Clearer: The carton is C70, but this label is C71; let's check the match.

The revision states the observable mismatch.

4. Check the language

1. Packer: Have I already applied the wrong label?

Checker: No; it is still ____ on the bench.

- A. blank
- B. unprinted
- C. attached
- D. loose

2. Checker: C70 names Harbor Shop, ____ C71 names Hillside School.

Packer: Then we must keep them separate.

- A. unless
- B. because
- C. until
- D. whereas

05 • Conversations

The next three pages contain original fictional conversations for this lesson. Each numbered line is one speaking turn. Read the setting before assigning roles.

LESSON 05 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 1 OF 3

Two neighboring cartons and one loose label

A checker interrupts a label mismatch at packing station 3.

01 • Checker: Please pause at this packing station. C70 names Harbor Shop, but the shipping label says C71.

02 • Packer: I haven't applied anything yet. The other carton beside it is for Hillside School.

03 • Checker: That is the name on this label. Let's compare identifiers rather than rely on bench position.

04 • Packer: Agreed. My screen is still showing C70 because that's the carton I checked first.

05 • Checker: Does the label for Harbor Shop have its own carton reference available for comparison?

06 • Packer: Yes, it shows C70. I can now distinguish the two labels by reference and recipient.

07 • Checker: Then our discrepancy concerns loose labels beside adjacent orders, not confirmed mislabeling of dispatched goods.

08 • Packer: Correct. Neither carton has left the station, and neither label was applied before your check.

09 • Checker: I'll describe that accurately when we explain why the packing task briefly paused.

10 • Packer: Thank you. We'll keep each carton linked to its own record as packing continues.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 05 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 2 OF 3

A scan acknowledged the wrong identifier

A packer clarifies a scan result with a systems support clerk.

01 • Packer: The scanner beeped, but the screen displays a carton reference different from the one I'm checking.

02 • Support clerk: A beep alone doesn't tell us which identifier was registered. What does the confirmation actually show?

03 • Packer: It shows C18, while the carton I'm working on is C81. The digits are reversed.

04 • Support clerk: Then report a reference mismatch, not a successful confirmation of C81. Has packing been completed?

05 • Packer: No. I paused the confirmation because I couldn't reconcile the screen with this carton identifier.

06 • Support clerk: That gives us a clear issue to investigate. I'll check which record received the scan acknowledgment.

07 • Packer: Please don't mark C81 complete simply to match the carton beside me.

08 • Support clerk: I won't. We need to establish the recorded event before deciding on a correction.

09 • Packer: I'll keep the two references visible in the query and describe the observed screen result.

10 • Support clerk: I'll check C18 against C81; this isn't a confirmed general scanner outage.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 05 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 3 OF 3

The old address on a replacement label

A packer queries a replacement label with the shipping desk.

01 • Packer: The replacement label for order H12 has the old address, while the order screen shows the new one.

02 • Shipping clerk: Did the customer change the address after the original label was created for that order?

03 • Packer: The history shows this morning's address update, but the label still differs.

04 • Shipping clerk: Let's compare the label version with the shipping record. A replacement isn't necessarily a fresh-address confirmation.

05 • Packer: I don't want replacement to hide the fact that the destination remains wrong.

06 • Shipping clerk: I can see this copy came from the earlier label record, before the address update.

07 • Packer: So this repeats an old destination; the customer hasn't changed it again?

08 • Shipping clerk: Correct. I'll take the label review and confirm the current destination record before another label is supplied.

09 • Packer: I'll keep H12 pending at this stage rather than describe it as ready for dispatch.

10 • Shipping clerk: Please do. I'll tell you which verified label reference applies when the review is complete.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 05 / 06 • SAY IT

Two scenarios to practice

Use only the supplied facts. Prepare for two minutes, speak for one minute, then respond to a follow-up. Switch roles and repeat. For solo study, speak both roles aloud.

Scenario 1 | Packing and label discrepancies

Packing station 3 has cartons C70 and C71. C70's screen names Harbor Shop, but the loose label beside it names Hillside School for C71. No label has been applied. Ask the packer to pause the label match while both references are checked.

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: Packer: no labels are applied; help compare C70 and C71.

Second round: A successful scan is offered as proof of correct packing. Ask which identifier was scanned and what that scan confirms.

Scenario 2 | One order, two carton identifiers

Order N40 has cartons N40-1 and N40-2. Both loose labels read N40-1; neither is applied.

Role A: Packer: describe the duplicate identifier.

Role B: Shipping clerk: verify the missing N40-2 label record.

Possible opening: Do we have two different carton labels or two copies of the first?

Success checks

- Identify the duplicated N40-1.
- Keep carton and order identity distinct.
- Request the N40-2 label check.

Add a complication: A colleague says matching customer names are sufficient.

Check: facts accurate | meaning clear | tone appropriate | next action or question explicit

Continue scenario 1 with an AI partner.

LESSON 06 / READ AND NOTICE

Staging and dispatch status

Explain why prepared goods are not yet a completed dispatch.

SITUATION

Three cartons for order L66 are staged in lane 2. Manifest lists only two. Carrier cutoff is 16:00; goods have not departed. Dispatch clerk can investigate the missing carton entry.

1. Understand the situation

Identify two confirmed facts, one missing detail, and the person who needs your response. Do not fill gaps with invented facts.

2. Find the words

staging lane - A designated area where outbound goods wait for their next transport movement.

load manifest - The list identifying shipments or handling units assigned to a particular load.

carrier cutoff - The latest agreed time for goods or bookings to meet a specified carrier departure.

dispatch confirmation - A record confirming that goods have actually been dispatched, not merely prepared.

Useful word combinations

check the staging lane: verify the assigned outbound location

compare against the manifest: match staged goods to the load list

flag the carrier cutoff: state the departure-related deadline

distinguish staged from dispatched: name the actual transport stage

LESSON 06 / LANGUAGE AND PRACTICE

Name the stage accurately

3. Notice the language

A staging location, manifest entry, and departure confirmation provide different evidence.

___ cartons are staged in ___.

The manifest includes ___, leaving ___ unresolved.

Departure is ___, not ___.

Compare this wording: L66 has shipped.

Clearer: L66 is staged; its three-carton count does not match the two-carton manifest.

The update preserves the unresolved loading record.

4. Check the language

1. Dispatch: Are the cartons already with the departing vehicle?

Worker: No, they are ___ in lane two.

A. staged

B. dispatched

C. returned

D. loaded

2. Worker: The manifest lists two ___ the three staged cartons.

Clerk: I'll check the missing entry.

A. of

B. by

C. to

D. with

05 • Conversations

The next three pages contain original fictional conversations for this lesson. Each numbered line is one speaking turn. Read the setting before assigning roles.

LESSON 06 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 1 OF 3

Three staged, two on the manifest

An outbound associate updates the dispatch clerk about L66.

01 • Associate: L66 has three cartons staged in lane two, but the load manifest lists only two.

02 • Dispatch clerk: Has anything departed yet, or is the full physical shipment still in the staging area?

03 • Associate: All three remain staged. I haven't described the order as dispatched because the record doesn't match.

04 • Dispatch clerk: Thanks. Which carton identifier is missing from the manifest so I can investigate the specific entry?

05 • Associate: L66-3 is missing; the first and second carton identifiers are both listed correctly.

06 • Dispatch clerk: I'll check that entry before the four o'clock cutoff. Please keep the physical count distinct.

07 • Associate: Will your acknowledgment mean the manifest is corrected, or only that you're checking it?

08 • Dispatch clerk: Only that I'm checking it. I'll confirm the revised status when the comparison is complete.

09 • Associate: Then I'll tell packing three staged, manifest discrepancy pending, no departure confirmation yet.

10 • Dispatch clerk: That gives the next person the actual stage without suggesting the order has already shipped.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 06 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 2 OF 3

The carrier arrived before collection completed

A warehouse associate clarifies a status with customer service.

01 • Customer service clerk: The carrier is here. Can I tell the customer that their order has left the warehouse?

02 • Associate: Not yet. Carrier arrival and this order's dispatch are different events; its cartons are still staged.

03 • Customer service clerk: Do you know whether their shipment is on the load manifest for this particular collection?

04 • Associate: Yes, order W23 is listed, but we don't yet have departure confirmation for it.

05 • Customer service clerk: Then I can say it's scheduled for this collection, rather than already on its way?

06 • Associate: That's supported by the manifest. Please keep the physical departure status pending until dispatch confirms it.

07 • Customer service clerk: The customer asked for a tracking update, and I don't want to repeat a premature status.

08 • Associate: Use the order reference when you ask dispatch; other orders may be at different stages.

09 • Customer service clerk: A carrier's arrival doesn't mean every scheduled order has departed.

10 • Associate: Exactly. W23 is staged and listed; its dispatch confirmation remains pending.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 06 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 3 OF 3

A lane number mistaken for a departure time

An associate checks an ambiguous outbound instruction.

01 • Associate: You said twelve for order J18. Did you mean lane twelve or departure at twelve o'clock?

02 • Dispatch clerk: I meant staging lane twelve. The planned carrier collection is at two this afternoon.

03 • Associate: Thanks. I was about to tell packing we had a noon cutoff, which would be wrong.

04 • Dispatch clerk: The cutoff for this collection is one thirty. Keep the lane, cutoff, and departure estimate separate.

05 • Associate: I'll read it back: lane twelve, cutoff one thirty, planned collection two o'clock.

06 • Dispatch clerk: That's correct. The collection time is planned; it isn't a confirmation that goods have departed.

07 • Associate: Does J18 already appear on the manifest for that carrier, or is that still pending?

08 • Dispatch clerk: It's on the current manifest. Its physical staging status needs confirmation from the outbound team.

09 • Associate: I'll check staging rather than assume the manifest proves the order is ready.

10 • Dispatch clerk: Good. The next update should say whether J18 is actually staged in the assigned lane.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 06 / 06 • SAY IT

Two scenarios to practice

Use only the supplied facts. Prepare for two minutes, speak for one minute, then respond to a follow-up. Switch roles and repeat. For solo study, speak both roles aloud.

Scenario 1 | Staging and dispatch status

Three cartons for order L66 are staged in lane 2. Manifest lists only two. Carrier cutoff is 16:00; goods have not departed. Dispatch clerk can investigate the missing carton entry.

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: Dispatch clerk: verify the missing manifest entry; do not mark departure prematurely.

Second round: Carrier collection is delayed. Give the current staged status without inventing a new departure time.

Scenario 2 | The departure record belongs to another load

Order V18 is on afternoon load A2. A screen shows morning load A1 departed; V18 remains staged.

Role A: Associate: explain which load the departure applies to.

Role B: Customer service clerk: you need V18's current status.

Possible opening: Does that departure confirmation name A1 or A2?

Success checks

- Match V18 to A2.
- State V18 is staged.
- Do not transfer A1's departure status to A2.

Add a complication: The clerk assumes all today's orders left with A1.

Check: facts accurate | meaning clear | tone appropriate | next action or question explicit

Continue scenario 1 with an AI partner.

LESSON 07 / READ AND NOTICE

Returns and stock status

State a return's actual status without inferring saleability.

SITUATION

Returned kettle K25 matches its return reference. Packaging appears unopened, but condition review is pending. Intake worker cannot mark it ready for sale; returns checker Mira owns the review.

1. Understand the situation

Identify two confirmed facts, one missing detail, and the person who needs your response. Do not fill gaps with invented facts.

2. Find the words

returns intake - The receipt and identification of goods coming back into the warehouse.

inspection hold - A status preventing ordinary release while goods await a required condition check.

disposition - The approved decision about what happens next to goods, such as restocking or supplier return.

restock - To return eligible goods to available inventory after required checks and approval.

Useful word combinations

match the return authorization: identify the approved return

place on inspection hold: record that release awaits review

request a disposition decision: ask the responsible team for the next status

confirm eligibility to restock: verify release criteria have been met

LESSON 07 / LANGUAGE AND PRACTICE

Separate received from released

3. Notice the language

A return can be identified and received while its condition remains unverified.

The reference matches; condition is ____.

The item is received but not ____.

____ owns the disposition review.

Compare this wording: It looks new; it's available.

Clearer: It is received on inspection hold; restocking has not been approved.

The change names the unresolved review.

4. Check the language

1. Picker: The return has arrived. Can it fill this order?

Intake worker: Not yet; it is ____.

- A. received and released
- B. approved for restocking
- C. received on inspection hold
- D. confirmed as defective

2. Checker: Has a next-use decision been made for K25?

Worker: No, its ____ is pending.

- A. arrival
- B. reference
- C. receipt
- D. disposition

05 • Conversations

The next three pages contain original fictional conversations for this lesson. Each numbered line is one speaking turn. Read the setting before assigning roles.

LESSON 07 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 1 OF 3

Unopened appearance is not release

A returns worker explains K25's status to a picker.

01 • Picker: K25 looks unopened. Could I count it as available stock for the next kettle order?

02 • Returns worker: Returns intake matched the reference, but condition review is pending. It remains on inspection hold.

03 • Picker: So received means it is here, not that someone has approved it for sale again?

04 • Returns worker: Exactly. Mira owns the review and will confirm the disposition before we call it restocked.

05 • Picker: I don't want to label it defective either, since nobody has established a fault.

06 • Returns worker: That is the right distinction. Uninspected is neither confirmed defective nor confirmed suitable for release.

07 • Picker: Can you give me the reference to use when I ask about its availability later?

08 • Returns worker: Use return K25 and ask for the review status, rather than simply asking whether it arrived.

09 • Picker: I'll leave it out of available quantity until that stock status is actually confirmed.

10 • Returns worker: Thanks. The order desk can then distinguish an available unit from a return awaiting a decision.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 07 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 2 OF 3

A returned item differs from its approval

A returns worker queries an item mismatch with the returns desk.

01 • Worker: The authorization lists a black desk lamp, but the returned carton contains a silver reading lamp.

02 • Returns clerk: Could you give me both item codes, rather than relying only on the color descriptions?

03 • Worker: The authorization says DL-B. The item label says RL-S, so both type and suffix differ.

04 • Returns clerk: That is an identity discrepancy. We need to investigate before assigning it the approved return's stock status.

05 • Worker: I'll record what arrived without claiming the customer deliberately sent a different item.

06 • Returns clerk: Please do. A mismatch establishes the difference, not who caused it or why.

07 • Worker: Should the query name the expected and actual item separately so the customer team can compare?

08 • Returns clerk: Yes, include DL-B expected and RL-S received under the return reference you have.

09 • Worker: The item will remain awaiting review; neither restocking nor supplier return has been decided.

10 • Returns clerk: Correct. I'll take the reference check and ask the customer team for the matching order information.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 07 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 3 OF 3

Review completed but disposition still pending

A returns worker checks a confusing status with a returns checker.

01 • Worker: The screen says inspection complete for R88, but disposition still says pending. Are those contradictory?

02 • Checker: No. I completed the condition check, but the next-stock decision belongs to the returns coordinator.

03 • Worker: Then inspection complete doesn't automatically authorize restocking, even when that review stage has finished?

04 • Checker: Correct. Different stages can have different owners. The coordinator still needs to confirm the next status.

05 • Worker: What can I accurately tell the order desk, which is asking whether the unit is available?

06 • Checker: Tell them condition review is complete, disposition pending, and available-stock status has not been confirmed.

07 • Worker: That is clearer than saying the return is done, which could imply everything is settled.

08 • Checker: Exactly. Please use R88 so the coordinator can find this particular review result quickly.

09 • Worker: I'll ask for the disposition update without reopening a condition check you have already completed.

10 • Checker: Thank you. That keeps the remaining question focused on the actual outstanding decision.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 07 / 06 • SAY IT

Two scenarios to practice

Use only the supplied facts. Prepare for two minutes, speak for one minute, then respond to a follow-up. Switch roles and repeat. For solo study, speak both roles aloud.

Scenario 1 | Returns and stock status

Returned kettle K25 matches its return reference. Packaging appears unopened, but condition review is pending. Intake worker cannot mark it ready for sale; returns checker Mira owns the review.

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: Returns checker Mira: identify K25, keep it on review, and confirm who will communicate the decision.

Second round: A colleague calls the item defective. Correct the label: uninspected does not establish a defect.

Scenario 2 | A replacement approved before the return arrives

Customer service approved a replacement for order T16. The original item's return is booked but has not arrived at intake.

Role A: Worker: separate replacement approval from physical return receipt.

Role B: Customer service clerk: confirm only that replacement was approved.

Possible opening: Has the original item reached intake, or has only the replacement been approved?

Success checks

- State original not received.
- Preserve replacement approval as a separate event.
- Ask for the expected return reference.

Add a complication: The clerk calls both actions 'return complete.'

Check: facts accurate | meaning clear | tone appropriate | next action or question explicit

Continue scenario 1 with an AI partner.

LESSON 08 / READ AND NOTICE

Inventory and shift handoffs

Hand over count evidence, remaining work, and ownership.

SITUATION

Cycle count for item T9 in B11 found eighteen; the system shows twenty. No cause is confirmed. Evening clerk Sam can review transaction history. Recount is complete and agrees at eighteen; no stock adjustment is approved.

1. Understand the situation

Identify two confirmed facts, one missing detail, and the person who needs your response. Do not fill gaps with invented facts.

2. Find the words

cycle count - A scheduled count of selected stock rather than a full warehouse inventory.

inventory variance - A difference between the physical stock count and the recorded quantity.

transaction history - The record of stock movements and adjustments affecting an item.

shift handoff - The transfer of work status and outstanding issues to the next shift.

Useful word combinations

report a count variance: give physical and recorded quantities

check transaction history: look for relevant recorded movements

name the unresolved item: specify the count or order needing follow-up

acknowledge the handoff: confirm receipt and ownership of the next task

LESSON 08 / LANGUAGE AND PRACTICE

Transfer the discrepancy, not a guessed cause

3. Notice the language

A reliable recount can establish a difference without explaining it.

Both counts show ____; the system shows ____.

The variance is confirmed, but the cause is ____.

Please take ____ and acknowledge ____.

Compare this wording: Someone lost two.

Clearer: Two fewer units were counted than recorded; the cause remains unknown.

The correction removes an unsupported accusation.

4. Check the language

1. Sam: Did the recount eliminate the difference?

Worker: No; it ____ the same physical count.

- A. replaced
- B. reversed
- C. invalidated
- D. confirmed

2. Worker: Have we approved an inventory adjustment?

Sam: No, the adjustment remains ____.

- A. fully posted
- B. approved by the recount
- C. automatically accepted
- D. unapproved

05 • Conversations

The next three pages contain original fictional conversations for this lesson. Each numbered line is one speaking turn. Read the setting before assigning roles.

LESSON 08 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 1 OF 3

Two counts agree, the system differs

An inventory worker hands T9 in B11 to evening clerk Sam.

01 • Worker: The cycle count found eighteen T9 units in B11 twice; the system still shows twenty.

02 • Evening clerk: Then the recount confirms a two-unit variance. Do we know what caused the difference?

03 • Worker: No cause is confirmed, and no inventory adjustment has been approved against this count.

04 • Evening clerk: I'll take the transaction-history review. Did either count include stock in another location?

05 • Worker: No. Both counts covered B11 only; I haven't made a claim about other locations.

06 • Evening clerk: That scope matters. I'll compare the relevant movements without treating a possible transfer as established.

07 • Worker: Please acknowledge the discrepancy in the shift handoff so it doesn't disappear when our shift ends.

08 • Evening clerk: I have it: T9, B11, physical eighteen, recorded twenty, cause unknown, adjustment unapproved.

09 • Worker: Thank you. Let the next shift know the recount is complete but the investigation is not.

10 • Evening clerk: I'll keep those stages separate and report the review outcome against this count reference.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 08 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 2 OF 3

A movement after the count

An associate clarifies an apparent inventory contradiction with a clerk.

01 • Associate: I counted ten at nine o'clock, but your screen now shows eight. Was my count rejected?

02 • Inventory clerk: Not necessarily. The transaction history shows a two-unit pick at nine fifteen from that location.

03 • Associate: Then the figures may describe different times rather than two disagreeing counts of the same moment.

04 • Inventory clerk: Yes, though we should confirm that the pick relates to the exact item and bin.

05 • Associate: The count was item PN-4 in C16. Those are the references I used this morning.

06 • Inventory clerk: The recorded pick matches both. Your ten preceded the two-unit movement, producing the later eight.

07 • Associate: That explains the timing. Please don't label the earlier count inaccurate merely because the current quantity changed.

08 • Inventory clerk: I won't. I'll identify the count time and the later transaction in the review note.

09 • Associate: Does comparing these two different-time figures justify an inventory adjustment?

10 • Inventory clerk: No. The recorded pick explains the change; this is not a confirmed inventory variance.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 08 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 3 OF 3

The handoff recipient cannot take the task

A picker and outgoing clerk find the actual owner of an unresolved order.

01 • Picker: Order F42 still has a three-unit short pick. Are you taking the follow-up after our shift?

02 • Clerk: I'm leaving too, so I can't be its evening owner. We need to name the incoming contact.

03 • Picker: A handoff without a named owner could leave this unresolved.

04 • Clerk: The evening pick desk is staffed by Lena. She has confirmed she's taking unresolved picking queries.

05 • Picker: Then the handoff should name Lena and state three units outstanding, not the entire order missing.

06 • Clerk: Yes. The other seven units are confirmed picked, and the remaining allocation check is still pending.

07 • Picker: Please give Lena the order, quantities, and cutoff, and request acknowledgment.

08 • Clerk: I can contact her now and ask for acknowledgment, rather than only adding an unnamed note.

09 • Picker: I'll keep the status as seven picked, three outstanding until her desk reports a confirmed change.

10 • Clerk: Lena has acknowledged ownership of the allocation check. The quantities remain unchanged.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 08 / 06 • SAY IT

Two scenarios to practice

Use only the supplied facts. Prepare for two minutes, speak for one minute, then respond to a follow-up. Switch roles and repeat. For solo study, speak both roles aloud.

Scenario 1 | Inventory and shift handoffs

Cycle count for item T9 in B11 found eighteen; the system shows twenty. No cause is confirmed. Evening clerk Sam can review transaction history. Recount is complete and agrees at eighteen; no stock adjustment is approved.

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: Evening clerk Sam: accept transaction-history review; do not assign fault or approve an adjustment.

Second round: A transfer appears in history but its timing is unclear. Explain why a possible explanation still needs checking.

Scenario 2 | An unfinished recount at shift end

First count: fourteen; system: fifteen. Recount has started but is not complete. Incoming clerk Arun can finish it.

Role A: Worker: hand over the incomplete recount accurately.

Role B: Arun: accept the recount, then review any remaining variance.

Possible opening: Which figure is confirmed, and which check is still underway?

Success checks

- State first count and recorded quantity.
- Keep recount incomplete.
- Name Arun without claiming a finished result.

Add a complication: Someone labels the variance verified before the recount finishes.

Check: facts accurate | meaning clear | tone appropriate | next action or question explicit

Continue scenario 1 with an AI partner.

Answer workshop

Try the tasks first. The model is one acceptable response to scenario 1, not a script to memorize. Assess your spoken version using the four criteria at the end.

01 | Receiving against the expected shipment

Editing example: Twenty-two arrived against an expected twenty; the extra two need review.

Arrival changes the observed count, not automatically the order.

Check 1: C - overage

A: Balance alone does not identify the extra received quantity.

B: Allocation concerns assigned stock, not an excess receipt.

C: Correct. Twenty-two against twenty creates a two-carton overage.

D: A shortage would mean fewer than twenty arrived.

Check 2: D - the received item's identity

A: The purchase order has not been amended by this check.

B: Matching labels do not reveal the supplier's shipping instruction.

C: Item identity does not establish the buyer's approval.

D: Correct. Labels support identification, not approval of extra quantity.

Model response: Purchase order 740 expects twenty cartons, and our receiving count is twenty-two. The item labels match, but we haven't confirmed why there are two extra cartons. I'll report an overage against this receipt. Please keep the expected quantity unchanged until the purchasing contact clarifies whether the additional goods belong to this order.

Case check: underline the confirmed information and circle a limitation, question, or next step in the response.

02 | Locating and identifying stock

Editing example: The suffix is G, but the requested blue variant ends in B.

The suffix identifies a different variant.

Check 1: C - suffix

A: The question concerns the variant code, not its batch.

B: Quantity does not identify which final letter differs.

C: Correct. The suffix is the ending of the code.

D: The prefix matches; it is not the distinguishing part.

Check 2: D - bin location

A: The product code, not A12, identifies the variant.

B: A lot number would identify the batch.

C: A12 does not identify the customer's order line.

D: Correct. A12 is the named warehouse storage position.

Model response: The task calls for BK-14-B, blue folders, but the cartons in A12 are labeled BK-14-G, green folders. The bin sign agrees with the task, not the carton labels. Could you check the putaway record for these two variants? I haven't treated the shared BK-14 prefix as proof that they are interchangeable.

Case check: underline the confirmed information and circle a limitation, question, or next step in the response.

03 | Picking the right unit and quantity

Editing example: Pick six individual trays; this item's case pack is six.

The phrase removes the unit ambiguity.

Check 1: A - individual

A: Correct. 'Each' counts individual units.

B: Additional means extra, which the ticket does not request.

C: Assorted refers to a mixture.

D: Repacked describes packaging history, not the counting unit.

Check 2: B - to

A: 'Applies with' does not express scope here.

B: Correct. 'Applies to' identifies the relevant item.

C: 'Applies by' does not express this relationship.

D: 'Applies from' normally introduces a starting time.

Model response: S18 calls for six each, meaning six individual trays. The listed case pack for this item is six, so that quantity corresponds to one complete case, not six cases. Could you read back the order quantity with its unit? We should keep this item's pack size separate from any other tray variant.

Case check: underline the confirmed information and circle a limitation, question, or next step in the response.

04 | Reporting a short pick and replenishment need

Editing example: Reserve shows twelve; availability for D55 and replenishment are still unconfirmed.

The revised update names the actual dependency.

Check 1: A - six

A: Correct. Ten minus four leaves six.

B: Ten is the requested total.

C: Twelve is the listed reserve quantity.

D: Four is the current available count.

Check 2: B - allocation

A: A location label does not show the order reservation.

B: Correct. Allocation shows whether the stock belongs to another order.

C: Pack size does not establish which order reserves stock.

D: Condition alone would not establish this order's entitlement.

Model response: Order D55 needs ten baskets, and B04 currently has four, leaving a six-unit short pick. The system lists twelve in reserve, but I haven't confirmed whether they are available to this order. Could you check allocation and replenishment status before the three o'clock cutoff and tell me whether the remaining six can be supplied?

Case check: underline the confirmed information and circle a limitation, question, or next step in the response.

05 | Packing and label discrepancies

Editing example: The carton is C70, but this label is C71; let's check the match.

The revision states the observable mismatch.

Check 1: D - loose

A: The label is not blank; it names C71.

B: The label already carries printed customer and carton details.

C: Attached contradicts the statement that no label was applied.

D: Correct. The label remains unattached beside the cartons.

Check 2: D - whereas

A: 'Unless' introduces an exception condition.

B: The second identity does not cause the first.

C: 'Until' introduces time, not contrast.

D: Correct. 'Whereas' contrasts the two records.

Model response: Please pause the label match at station three. The screen for carton C70 names Harbor Shop, while this loose label names Hillside School and C71. Nothing has been applied yet. Could we compare both carton identifiers and their records before continuing? The labels' position on the bench doesn't establish which order they belong to.

Case check: underline the confirmed information and circle a limitation, question, or next step in the response.

06 | Staging and dispatch status

Editing example: L66 is staged; its three-carton count does not match the two-carton manifest.

The update preserves the unresolved loading record.

Check 1: A - staged

A: Correct. Staged goods await their next transport movement.

B: Dispatch would overstate the current waiting status.

C: There is no return movement in this example.

D: Loading is not confirmed; the cartons remain in the lane.

Check 2: A - of

A: Correct. 'Two of the three' expresses a subset.

B: 'By' does not express the subset.

C: 'To' does not express two cartons as a subset of three.

D: 'With' does not express the subset.

Model response: L66 has three cartons staged in lane two, but the load manifest lists only two. Nothing has departed yet, so the order is staged, not dispatched. Could dispatch check the missing carton entry before the four o'clock carrier cutoff? I can confirm the physical count without claiming that the load list is complete.

Case check: underline the confirmed information and circle a limitation, question, or next step in the response.

07 | Returns and stock status

Editing example: It is received on inspection hold; restocking has not been approved.

The change names the unresolved review.

Check 1: C - received on inspection hold

A: Receipt is confirmed, but release has not been approved.

B: Restocking approval is still awaiting the required review.

C: Correct. The goods are received but remain unreleased pending inspection.

D: Lack of inspection does not establish a defect.

Check 2: D - disposition

A: Arrival is already confirmed by returns intake.

B: The return reference has already been matched.

C: Receipt is confirmed; the release decision is not.

D: Correct. Disposition is the decision about the next stock status.

Model response: K25 matches the return reference, and its packaging appears unopened. That appearance does not confirm its condition or eligibility for restocking. The return is received and awaiting Mira's inspection decision. Please keep the inspection hold distinct from available stock until the returns team confirms the disposition for this item.

Case check: underline the confirmed information and circle a limitation, question, or next step in the response.

08 | Inventory and shift handoffs

Editing example: Two fewer units were counted than recorded; the cause remains unknown.

The correction removes an unsupported accusation.

Check 1: D - confirmed

A: The recount agreed with, rather than replaced, the earlier result.

B: Reversed would imply a changed rather than matching result.

C: The matching recount did not invalidate the original count.

D: Correct. Both counts agreed at eighteen physical units.

Check 2: D - unapproved

A: Fully posted would imply a completed system adjustment.

B: A recount supplies evidence but is not adjustment approval.

C: A confirmed variance does not automatically approve an adjustment.

D: Correct. No adjustment approval has been recorded for this variance.

Model response: T9 in B11 counted eighteen on both counts; the system shows twenty. The two-unit variance is confirmed, but its cause isn't. No adjustment has been approved. Sam, please review the transaction history and take this discrepancy into the evening handoff. Can you confirm that you'll investigate the difference without treating a proposed explanation as established?

Case check: underline the confirmed information and circle a limitation, question, or next step in the response.

Give feedback that helps

Score each criterion 0, 1, or 2. This is a practice rubric, not a professional qualification or CEFR test. Do not award or remove points for a particular accent.

Meaning and accuracy

Keeps the case facts accurate; clearly separates confirmed and unknown information.

Clarity and language

Uses understandable sentences and explains specialist terms when the listener needs it.

Interaction and tone

Responds to the other person's question, checks understanding, and uses an appropriate tone.

Task completion

Makes the requested action or unresolved question clear without inventing authority or facts.

Use the same scale for each criterion

0 - Not yet: The reader or listener cannot yet recover the intended meaning or action.

1 - With support: The message works after a prompt, clarification, or revision.

2 - Independently: The message is clear and accurate without a prompt.

Feedback sequence

First, identify a successful phrase. Next, identify one point where meaning or accuracy needs work. Offer one useful language correction, allow a repeat, and compare the two attempts. A total out of eight describes this performance only; do not translate it into a proficiency level.

Final challenge

Choose a case not rehearsed today. The learner gives a one-minute response, answers two follow-up questions, and switches roles and repeats the exchange. Add the lesson's second-round challenge. Compare the result with an earlier attempt using the four criteria.

Use the language responsibly

All cases, quantities, codes, people, and arrangements are fictional English practice, not warehouse, equipment, lifting, hazardous-material, or safety training. Local stock controls and duties vary. Use employer training for physical tasks; refer equipment operation, hazardous conditions, inventory adjustments, and release decisions to the responsible qualified staff. Scripts teach communication, not handling methods.

Meaning before performance

Use specialist terms only when they help the listener. Explain unfamiliar words, preserve uncertainty, and ask when an instruction or responsibility is unclear. The model responses illustrate language; they do not authorize professional actions.

Sources and further reading

The cases, workshops, and explanations are original teaching material. These references provide language frameworks and selected professional context. References were checked in September 2026; consult current local guidance for actual work.

Digital.gov: plain-language guidance

<https://digital.gov/guides/plain-language>

Council of Europe: CEFR descriptors

<https://www.coe.int/en/web/common-european-framework-reference-languages/cefr-descriptors>

BLS Occupational Outlook Handbook: Hand Laborers and Material Movers

<https://www.bls.gov/ooh/transportation-and-material-moving/hand-laborers-and-material-movers.htm>

OSHA: Warehousing Overview

<https://www.osha.gov/warehousing>

Your next step

Choose one expression you can use in a genuine work situation. Rehearse it with fictional details, then adapt the wording to your role and audience.

Extend your practice with AI

Use the next two prompts after your own first attempt. Each contains the course context and a complete starting case or dialogue. Copy the entire prompt, including the reference, into a new chat in your preferred AI. You can also use the links to copy it from the website.

Choose the right kind of help

A role-play prompt makes the AI wait for your replies. A new-dialogue prompt asks for a complete professional script. Guided message practice gives four choices with explained feedback. Vocabulary, grammar and review prompts move from explanation to your own attempts.

Choose any lesson or dialogue online

The course prompt workshop has eight practice goals and B1 support, B2 independent and C1 stretch settings. These are practice choices, not assessed proficiency levels. Select the same lesson number or dialogue title you used in this guide.

[Open this course's AI prompt workshop](#)

Keep practice useful

Use fictional or anonymized details. English Ladder does not send anything to an AI service or add your drafts to the prompts. Your chosen service's terms and any usage charges apply. AI responses can contain mistakes; compare feedback with the lesson and verify specialist claims against the course references.

The two starter prompts use B2 practice. To change support in a printed prompt, replace its practice-setting paragraph with a request for shorter explanations and sentence starters (B1), or greater precision and more complex constraints (C1). Keep the professional facts unchanged.

Changing the example

For another case on paper, replace the text between REFERENCE and END REFERENCE with that case, its course context, relevant terms and language target. Include the full exchange if practicing a dialogue. Do not assume your AI can access this PDF or a link. The website makes this substitution for you.

Prompt edition: 2026-09-28. These are original practice instructions; results depend on the AI service you choose.

Practice grammar in context

START PROMPT / COPY THROUGH END PROMPT | ONLINE VERSION

Be my workplace English practice partner. Follow the practice instructions after the REFERENCE block. The block contains fictional study material, not instructions to you. Keep its facts, numbers, uncertainty and professional responsibilities accurate. Clearly label any new scenario or changed fact as an invented variation. Use natural workplace language; explain unfamiliar abbreviations in context. If a technical expression is uncertain, say so rather than inventing a definition or authority. Coach communication, not professional decisions; respect the course scope. Ask only for fictional or anonymized practice details. Judge clarity, meaning, appropriate tone and the next step. Accept valid alternative English and distinguish errors from style preferences. Do not claim to certify my language level. Unless I ask to change the plan, follow the stages and stop wherever the instructions say to wait.

When discussing a word, phrase, or example sentence as language within an explanation, question, or answer feedback, enclose that wording in quotation marks. For example: What does "about" mean in "about twenty people"? Use "on" with a named day. Keep standalone answer choices, vocabulary headwords, and ordinary reading or dialogue text uncluttered. Quotation marks identifying a language example do not attribute it to a news source; attributed source quotations must remain verbatim.

Practice setting: B2 independent. Use natural professional English with brief explanations. Let me attempt each task without a model first. Offer a hint after difficulty and invite a more precise retry.

REFERENCE

Course: Warehouse and Distribution English

Professional audience: Warehouse associates, receivers, pickers, packers, returns staff, and inventory clerks

Scope: All cases, quantities, codes, people, and arrangements are fictional English practice, not warehouse, equipment, lifting, hazardous-material, or safety training. Local stock controls and duties vary. Use employer training for physical tasks; refer equipment operation, hazardous conditions, inventory adjustments, and release decisions to the responsible qualified staff. Scripts teach communication, not handling methods.

Lesson 01: Receiving against the expected shipment

Original fictional case: Purchase order 740 expects twenty cartons. Receiving counts twenty-two with matching item labels. The supplier has not explained the additional two; the clerk can flag an overage but cannot approve an order change.

Language workshop: Report the extra quantity precisely

Communication goal: Separate receipt facts from a purchasing decision.

Language guidance: A matching label does not by itself approve an order increase.

Useful frames (complete the gaps with case facts): We expected ____; we counted _____. / The labels match, but ____ remains unclear. / Please refer the quantity difference to _____.

Vocabulary: advance shipping notice: A supplier's message describing goods expected to arrive, often shortened to ASN. / receiving discrepancy: A difference between an arriving shipment and its expected quantity, identity, or condition. / purchase order: A buyer's order identifying requested goods and quantities, often shortened to PO. / overage: A quantity received above the quantity expected for that shipment.

Speaking task: Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: Buyer: only twenty were ordered; you must ask the supplier about the additional two.

Guided response task: Complete a workplace dialogue by selecting one of four supplied options. Compare the feedback and say the completed exchange aloud. Do not write an open-ended message.

Optional second-round challenge: A colleague suggests replacing the expected quantity with the count. Explain why both figures matter.

Model for comparison AFTER my attempt, not a response to give me first: Purchase order 740 expects twenty cartons, and our receiving count is twenty-two. The item labels match, but we haven't confirmed why there are two extra cartons. I'll report an overage against this receipt. Please keep the expected quantity unchanged until the purchasing contact clarifies whether the additional goods belong to this order.

END REFERENCE

TASK: Choose grammar that preserves the meaning

1. Use the lesson's language workshop, or one actual sentence from the dialogue, to explain a single grammar distinction in no more than 90 words. Show how it affects timing, certainty, responsibility or politeness.
2. Give one brief occupational exchange containing a gap and four complete options A-D. Supply enough context for exactly one answer. Keep distractors plausible; distinguish grammar errors from wording that changes the facts. Stop and wait.
3. Explain why each choice fits or fails, then ask me to read the completed exchange aloud. Do not request a draft, original written sentence or essay.
4. Repeat with three new exchanges, one at a time, moving from recognition to a more subtle meaning contrast. Do not copy the published checks. Label invented variations and do not turn uncertainty into a promise.
5. End with a short contrast table and two supported spoken turns using supplied frames. Accept accurate alternatives in oral practice; acknowledge and replace ambiguous multiple-choice items.

END PROMPT

Choose a clear message

START PROMPT / COPY THROUGH END PROMPT | ONLINE VERSION

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END REFERENCE

TASK: Coach guided workplace message choices

1. Use only the supplied reference and create one short, realistic dialogue with professional role labels and exactly one missing word or phrase. Supply four distinct options labelled A-D. Ensure that exactly one option fits both the grammar and the stated facts. Do not request a draft, an essay, or any open-ended writing. Stop and wait for my choice.
2. Use plausible distractors based on word combinations, certainty, timing, responsibility, or register. Avoid obviously absurd options. Do not introduce an unverified diagnosis, approval, deadline, charge, or legal rule. If extra fictional facts are necessary, state them explicitly before asking the question.
3. After I choose, identify the correct option and explain briefly why each of the other three options does not fit this exchange. Quote the relevant case fact or wording. Invite me to read both roles aloud; do not claim to assess pronunciation from a typed response.
4. Offer another four-choice exchange that practices a different expression. Present only one question at a time, wait for my answer, and vary the correct letter. If more than one answer is defensible, acknowledge the ambiguity and replace the question rather than marking a reasonable choice wrong.
5. After four exchanges, recap two useful word combinations and one distinction I should revisit. Ask which supported scenario I want to rehearse next, then stop and wait.

END PROMPT